



RAOH

— R e s e a r c h e r s —

RESEARCH. DISCOVER. IMPACT.

Advancing knowledge.
Creating real-world impact.



Introduction

Purpose of the Introduction

The Introduction explains the background of the topic, identifies the research problem, highlights the knowledge gap, and states the study objective.

Structure of an Introduction

1. General Background

Introduce the topic and explain its importance.

2. Current Evidence

Summarize key findings from previous studies relevant to the topic.

3. Research Gap

Identify what remains unknown, controversial, or insufficiently studied.

4. Study Rationale

Explain why addressing this gap is important.

5. Study Objective

Conclude with a clear statement of the study aim and/or hypothesis.

Funnel Structure

Broad Topic → Current Evidence → Knowledge Gap → Study Rationale → Study Objective

Citation Tips

- Nearly every factual claim should be supported by a citation.
- Cite the source immediately after the statement it supports.
- Prefer original studies, systematic reviews, and meta-analyses when appropriate.
- Use recent references whenever possible.
- Ensure that the cited article actually supports the statement being made.
- Do not cite papers you have not read.
- Avoid excessive citations for simple statements.

Examples

Correct:

Medical students frequently experience sleep deprivation due to demanding academic schedules.¹

Correct:

Several studies have reported an association between poor sleep quality and reduced academic performance among medical students.^{2–4}

Incorrect:

Medical students frequently experience sleep deprivation due to demanding academic schedules.

(No citation provided for a factual claim.)

Synthesizing Evidence**Good:**

Previous studies have shown that poor sleep is associated with impaired cognitive performance, increased stress levels, and lower academic achievement among university students.^{3–6}

Poor:

Study A found poor sleep.¹

Study B found poor sleep.²

Study C found poor sleep.³

Rather than listing studies individually, summarize their collective findings.

Presenting Statistics**Correct:**

The prevalence of burnout among medical students has been reported to exceed 40% in some populations.⁷

Weak:

Burnout is very common among medical students.

Numerical claims should generally be supported by citations.

Introducing the Research Gap

Although several studies have examined sleep quality among medical students, limited evidence is available regarding its relationship with chronic musculoskeletal pain in Middle Eastern populations.^{8–10}

Stating the Objective

Therefore, this study aimed to investigate the association between sleep quality and chronic musculoskeletal pain among medical students in Jordan.

Writing Tips

- Write from general to specific.
- Keep paragraphs logically connected.
- Focus only on information relevant to the research question.
- Use clear scientific language.
- End the Introduction with the study objective.
- Do not discuss your results or conclusions.

Common Mistakes

- Writing a literature review instead of an Introduction.
- Listing studies without synthesizing them.
- Making unsupported claims.
- Failing to identify a clear research gap.
- Using outdated references.
- Stating the study objective too early.

AI Usage

Many journals allow AI-assisted writing if disclosed appropriately (e.g., in the Acknowledgements or Methods section). AI should be used only for writing assistance. Authors remain responsible for verifying all references, data, analyses, results, and interpretations. AI should not be relied upon for independent analysis, scientific interpretation, or citation generation without verification.

Final Checklist

- ✓ Every major claim is referenced.
- ✓ The literature is synthesized rather than listed.
- ✓ The research gap is clearly identified.
- ✓ The study objective is explicit.
- ✓ References are accurate, relevant, and up to date.
- ✓ The Introduction logically leads to the research question.

Golden Rule

What is known? → What is unknown? → Why does it matter? → What will this study investigate?